At a crucial time, Harbhajan Singh and Sameer Dighe, our wicketkeeper and my very close friend, put together a partnership that, though not a big one, was perhaps the most significant of the series. Fighting unbelievable pressure, they somehow held things together to take us over the line and the rest of the team were in raptures. The way the two of them ran the winning runs was almost comical, but it was an incredible feeling to know we had won the match and the series. We were all shouting with delight and handing out high-fives and hugs. We had beaten the best team in the world and it felt truly amazing to have accomplished what I had predicted before the start of the contest. We had put the Australians under pressure and had reaped the rewards for doing so. The whole team had stuck together despite losing the first Test, and this series is without doubt one of the best I have played in my career.

Coming at a critical time, the series also helped restore Indian fans' faith in the game. Cricket had once again triumphed over all odds. Both teams had played hard cricket and the passion and intensity was at a high level throughout. Played before huge crowds, it was the best possible advertisement for Test cricket. To Australia's credit, they were always competitive and had actually come close to winning in Chennai themselves, picking up eight Indian wickets in the second innings.

As we celebrated the series win I remember being very pleased to see Anil, who had not played a part in the series because of injury. He had been present in the pre-series training camp and had come along to cheer on the team during the third and deciding Test.

During the ODI series that followed, which we lost 2–3, I reached 10,000 runs in ODIs, in the third game in Indore, and in the last match in Goa I did something that I have never done again in my life. I injured my index finger and ended up bowling off-spin with my middle finger for ten overs, picking up 3–35 in the spell, including the wicket of Steve Waugh. The moment Waugh came in to bat I started gesturing towards the midwicket fielder, suggesting to Waugh that I would get him out there. It was friendly banter and Waugh retorted by saying I wasn't playing in my garden. As luck would have it, Steve tried playing a slog sweep to midwicket and was caught there by Ajit Agarkar.

Australia in India 2001 – The Border-Gavaskar Trophy

1st Test. Mumbai. 27 February–March 1 2001